

Yurika Aonuki

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EDUCATION

- 2022-2027 Ph.D. in Linguistics at Massachusetts Institute of Technology (expected June 2027)
Dissertation: Grammars of *de re* readings and their cousins
- 2019-2021 M.A. in Linguistics at University of British Columbia
Thesis: Relative pronominal tense: Evidence from Gitksan, Japanese, and English [\[link\]](#)
- 2016-2019 B.A. Honours in Linguistics at University of British Columbia
Thesis: Adjective intensification in American Sign Language [\[link\]](#)

PUBLICATIONS

Journal articles

- Aonuki, Yurika (2026). “Scale-sensitivity of comparatives and measure phrase interpretations in Gitksan”. In: *Semantics of Natural Languages* 1.1, pp. 1–48. [\[link\]](#).
- Bertrand, Anne, Yurika Aonuki, Sihwei Chen, Henry Davis, Joash Gambarage, Laura Griffin, Marianne Huijsmans, Lisa Matthewson, Daniel Reisinger, Hotze Rullmann, Raiane Salles, Michael David Schwan, Neda Todorović, Bailey Trotter, and Jozina Vander Klok (2022). “Nobody’s perfect”. In: *Languages* 7.2, pp. 1–28. [\[link\]](#).
- Tkachman, Oksana, Kathleen Currie Hall, Robert Fuhrman, and Yurika Aonuki (2019). “Visible amplitude: Towards quantifying prominence in sign language”. In: *Journal of Phonetics* 77, pp. 1–23. [Editor’s choice, [link](#)].

Conference proceedings (reviewed by abstract)

- Aonuki, Yurika (to appear). “‘Irrealis’ *ji* in declarative and interrogative complements in Gitksan”. In: *Proceedings of West Coast Conference in Formal Linguistics (WCCFL)* 43. Somerville, MA: Cascadia Press. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika (to appear). “What questions, conditionals, uncertainty, and falsity share in Gitksan”. In: *Proceedings of Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW)* 48. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika and Kathryn Davidson (2026). “On the QUD sensitivity of a third reading”. In: *Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung* 30. University of Konstanz, pp. 35–52. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika (2025a). “Decomposing ‘minimum-standard gradable adjectives’ in Japanese as verbal *-tei-* predicates”. In: *Proceedings of West Coast Conference in Formal Linguistics (WCCFL)* 42. Somerville, MA: Cascadia Press, pp. 28–35. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika (2025b). “Differential measure phrases with implicit comparatives in Gitksan”. In: *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 34. University of Rochester, pp. 132–153. [\[link\]](#).

- Aonuki, Yurika (2024a). “Covert relative non-future tense in Gitksan”. In: *Proceedings of West Coast Conference in Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 39*. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press, pp. 441–449. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika (2024b). “Inherently context-sensitive gradable adjectives”. In: *Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 28*. Ed. by Geraldine Baumann, Daniel Gutzmann, Jonas Koopman, Kristina Liefke, Agata Renans, and Tatjana Scheffler. Ruhr-Universität Bochum, pp. 58–76. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika (2022a). “Free relatives in Gitksan”. In: *Proceedings of Semantics of Under-Represented Languages in the Americas (SULA) 11*. University of Massachusetts Amherst GLSA, pp. 1–16. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika (2022b). “Morphological tenselessness and SOT: Evidence for a covert relative pronominal tense in Gitksan”. In: *Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 26*. Universität zu Köln, pp. 55–73. [\[link\]](#).
- Hall, Kathleen Currie, Oksana Tkachman, and Yurika Aonuki (2022). “Perceived Magnitudes of Movement in American Sign Language”. In: *Proceedings of Chicago Linguistics Society (CLS) 57*. IL: University of Chicago, pp. 187–211. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika (2020). “Unifying the ‘still’ and ‘just’ readings of *k’ay* in Gitksan”. In: *Proceedings of West Coast Conference in Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 37*. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press, pp. 68–78. [\[link\]](#).
- Aonuki, Yurika (2019). “Adjective Intensification in American Sign Language”. In: *Proceedings of Canadian Linguistics Association (CLA) 2019*. Vancouver: University of British Columbia. [\[link\]](#).

Conference presentations (reviewed by abstract)

- Aonuki, Yurika (2026a). Questions and conditionals with disjunction in Gitksan. *Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW) 48*, University of Siena, 21-23 April.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2026b). Questions and conditionals with disjunction in Gitksan. *SULA-Triple A 2026*, University of British Columbia, 12-15 May.
- Momma, Shota, Yurika Aonuki, Victor S. Ferreira, Gianluca Porta, and Martin Hackl (2026). How is *did* like *that?*: Hyper-abstract grammatical generalization in speaking. *Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP) 39*, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, 26-28 March.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2025). ‘Irrealis’ particle *ji* in Gitksan. *West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 43*, University of Washington, 25-27 April.
- Aonuki, Yurika and Kathryn Davidson (2025). On the QUD sensitivity of a third reading. *Sinn und Bedeutung 30*, Goethe University Frankfurt, 24-26 September.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2024a). Comparatives and differential measure phrases without *-er* in Gitksan. *Semantics and Linguistics Theory (SALT) 34*, University of Rochester, 28-30 May.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2024b). Inherent context sensitivity in two unrelated degreeful languages. *Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS) 60*, 26-28 April.

- Aonuki, Yurika (2024c). Minimum-standard predicates as resultatives and measure phrase interpretations. *West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 42*, University of California Berkeley, 12-14, April.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2023). Evaluativity in Japanese degree constructions. *Sinn und Bedeutung 28*, Ruhr University Bochum, 5-8, September.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2021a). An account of morphological tenselessness in Gitksan inspired by SOT in English. *Sinn und Bedeutung 26*, University of Cologne, 8-10 September.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2021b). Covert relative pronominal tense in Gitksan. *Workshop on Structure and Constituency in Languages of the Americas (WSCLA) 25*, Sogang University, 28-30 May.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2021c). Decomposing the covert non-future tense in Gitksan. *West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 39*, University of Arizona, 8 - 11, April.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2021d). Revisiting pronominal vs. existential past tense denotations in English and Japanese. *Canadian Linguistics Association (CLA) 2021*, virtual, 4-7 June.
- Kathleen Currie Hall Oksana Tkachman, Yurika Aonuki (2021). Perceived Magnitudes of Movement in American Sign Language. *Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS) 57*, 6-8, May.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2020a). Free relatives in Gitksan. *Semantics of Under-Represented Languages in the Americas (SULA) 11*, El Colegio de México and Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México, 28-3, May.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2020b). Unifying the ‘still’ and ‘just’ readings of *k’ay* in Gitksan. *West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 37*, Univeristy of British Columbia, March 6-8, 2020.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2019a). Adjective Intensification in American Sign Language. *Canadian Linguistics Association*, University of British Columbia, 1-3 June, 2019.
- Aonuki, Yurika (2019b). Phonology of adjective intensification in American Sign Language. *Language Sciences Undergraduate Research Conference (LSURC) 2019*, University of British Columbia, 8-9 February. [Best presentation award].
- Hall, Kathleen Currie, Oksana Tkachman, and Yurika Aonuki (2019a). Lexical competition and articulatory enhancement in American Sign Language. *Canadian Linguistics Association (CLA) 2019*, University of British Columbia, 1-3 June.
- Hall, Kathleen Currie, Oksana Tkachman, and Yurika Aonuki (2019b). Lexical competition correlates with articulatory enhancement in ASL. *Theoretical Issues in Sign Language Research (TISLR) 13*, Universität Hamburg, 26-28 September.
- Tkachman, Oksana, Robert Fuhrman, Kathleen Currie Hall, Yurika Aonuki, and Bryan Gick (2018). Visible Energy in signed languages: Explaining a trade-off between sign location and sign handedness. *Laboratory Phonology (LabPhon) 16*, Universidade de Lisboa, 19-22 June.

Special issues

Aonuki, Yurika (2024). “Degree constructions in Gitksan”. In: *The title of this volume is shorter than its contributions are allowed to be: Papers in honour of Hotze Rullmann*. Ed. by M. Ryan Bochnak, Eva Csipak, Lisa Matthewson, Marcin Morzycki, and Daniel K. E. Reisinger. Vancouver, BC: UBCOPL, pp. 1–18.

Yurika Aonuki, Kathleen Currie Hall (2024). “Incorporating sign language phonetics and phonology exercises into the Linguistics classroom”. In: *The title of this volume is shorter than its contributions are allowed to be: Papers in honour of Hotze Rullmann*. Ed. by M. Ryan Bochnak, Eva Csipak, Lisa Matthewson, Marcin Morzycki, and Daniel K. E. Reisinger. Vancouver, BC: UBCOPL, pp. 19–38.

Invited talks

Aonuki, Yurika (2025). Differential measure phrases and comparatives in Gitksan. Invited talk at Aoyama Gakuin University, 5 August.

Aonuki, Yurika (2023). Degree semantics in Gitksan and Japanese. Invited talk at University of British Columbia Linguistics Outside the Classroom, 11 August.

Aonuki, Yurika (2022). Relative pronominal tense in Gitksan and Japanese. Invited talk at UC Berkeley Syntax and Semantics Circle, 18 February.

Aonuki, Yurika (2019). Adjective intensification in American Sign Language. Invited talk at The 50th Anniversary of the UBC Linguistics Department, 15-18 May.

Hall, Kathleen Currie, Yurika Aonuki, Oksana Tkachman, Li Ze Choo, Terrance Gatchalian, Cristina Lee, Elizabeth Tiamzon, and Mai Tran (2019). Integrating sign languages into the linguistics classroom. Invited talk at UBC Teaching and Learning Enhancement Fund Showcase, 2 May.

FIELDWORK EXPERIENCE

Fieldwork on Gitksan 2018 - present

– Semantic investigation of tense and aspect, free relatives, attitude reports, conditionals, embedded questions, and degree constructions with a total of four speakers representing three dialects.

Fieldwork on American Sign Language 2019

– Phonological investigation of adjective intensification with a fluent Deaf signer.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching assistant

MIT 24.973 ‘Advanced Semantics’ 2025 Spring

MIT 24.900 ‘Introduction to Linguistics’ 2023 Fall

UBC Ling 333 ‘Research Methods for Linguistics’ 2021 Summer 1

UBC Ling 201 ‘Linguistic Theory and Analysis II’ (syntax, semantics) 2020 Winter 2

UBC Ling 200 ‘Linguistic Theory and Analysis I’ (phonology, phonetics) 2020 Winter 1

UBC Ling 100 ‘Introduction to Language and Linguistics’ 2020 Summer 1, Winter 1

Tutor

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH AND MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Project coordinator for a project on sign languages

2017 – 2019, 2021 – 2022

(supervisor: Kathleen Currie Hall)

- Designed and tested parts of a novel transcription software *Sign Language Phonetic Annotator-Analyzer*.
- Developed documentation for the software, and trained six undergraduate students to transcribe sign language data using the software.
- Created problem sets using sign language data for the undergraduate phonology curriculum.

Research Assistant

2019 – 2021

(supervisor: Lisa Matthewson)

- Organized bi-weekly meetings and created long-term agendas for the Tense and Aspect in the Pacific Lab.
- Glossed and archived Gitksan data from semantic fieldwork.

REVIEWING

Semantic Fieldwork Methods (journal)	2025 –
Natural Language Semantics (journal)	2026 –
SULA-Triple A (conference)	2026 –

SERVICE

MIT Women's Advisory Group,	Graduate Rep.	2024 – 2025
MIT Linguistics Colloquia Committee,	Co-Organizer	2023 – 2025
UBC Linguistics Curriculum Committee,	Graduate Rep.	2021
UBC Linguistics Colloquia Committee,	Co-Organizer	2019 – 2021
UBC Linguistics Semantics Search Committee,	Undergraduate Rep.	2019
UBC Language Sciences Undergraduate Research Conference,	Co-Organizer	2018

AWARDS AND GRANTS

MIT Ken Hale Fund	2026	\$3,000(USD)
MIT Ken Hale Fund	2024	\$1,500(USD)
MIT Ken Hale Fund	2023	\$2285(USD)
MIT Ken Hale Fund	2022	\$1500(USD)
The Jacobs Research Funds (co-applicant)	2020	\$7,886(CAD)
UBC Arts Graduate Research Award	2020	\$980(CAD)
UBC Fellowship Competition	2020	\$16,000(CAD)
UBC LSURC Best Presentation Award	2019	N/A
UBC Faculty of Arts International Student Scholarship	2017	\$5,000(CAD)
UBC Trek Excellence Scholarship	2017	\$4,000(CAD)
UBC Work Learn International Undergraduate Research Award	2017	\$4,500(CAD)
UBC Outstanding International Student Award	2016	\$6,000(CAD)

LANGUAGES

Japanese	native
English	proficient
American Sign Language	intermediate; one year of phonological fieldwork
Gitksan	eight years of semantic fieldwork